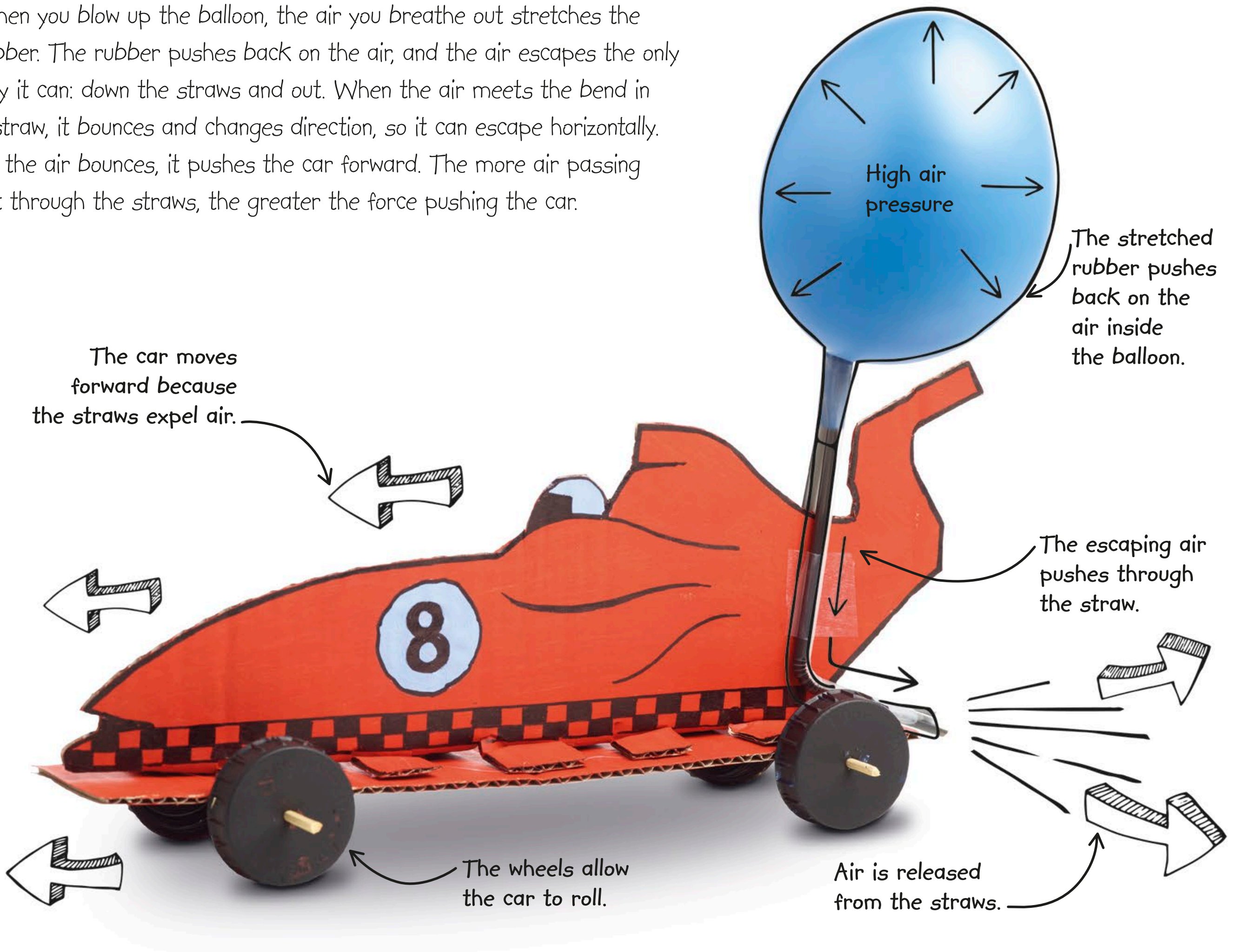
HOW IT WORKS

When you blow up the balloon, the air you breathe out stretches the rubber. The rubber pushes back on the air, and the air escapes the only way it can: down the straws and out. When the air meets the bend in a straw, it bounces and changes direction, so it can escape horizontally. As the air bounces, it pushes the car forward. The more air passing out through the straws, the greater the force pushing the car.



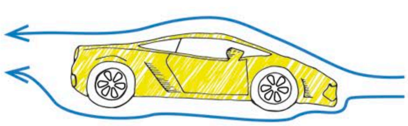
REAL WORLD SCIENCE

JET ENGINE

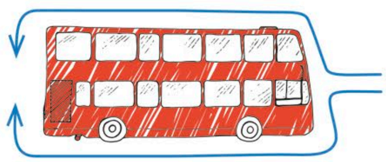
In a jet engine, spinning turbine blades draw in air. Heating and compression forms hot gas that escapes through the exhaust nozzle of the aircraft. As this gas shoots backward, it pushes the aircraft forward at high speed.

AIR RESISTANCE

Cars are designed to be sleek, creating as little air resistance, or drag, as possible. As a vehicle moves, it pushes air out of the way.



Pointed vehicles, such as many sports cars, slice through air—they are streamlined and can move very fast.



Square- or rectangular-shaped vehicles, including buses, experience more drag, which slows them down much more.